AI FOR HUMANITY

CoU AI Hackathon 2026

Official Rule Book

Pre-build 21 – 23 November | Final 24 November 2026 | Comilla University

Revised edition, 12 November 2026

EVENT OVERVIEW

The event at a glance

3 days	5 hrs	30	Tk 25,000
Pre-build (21 – 23 Nov)	On-site final (24 Nov)	Finalist teams	Total prize pool

Who can join

Currently enrolled students of any university in Bangladesh, in teams of 1 – 3. Cross-university teams are welcome.

What you build

A working AI project that solves a real problem: built during the 21 – 23 Nov pre-build and finished at the five-hour on-site final.

What it costs

Pre-registration is free. Only the Top 30 selected teams pay Tk 1,350 per team.

KEY DATES

Four steps to the final

1

12 – 18 Nov

Phase 1: Pre-registration

Free registration and idea proposal submission

2

19 – 20 Nov

Idea evaluation

Organizers review proposals and publish the Top 30

3

21 – 23 Nov

Phase 2: Pre-build and payment

Selected teams build their project and pay the fee to confirm their seat

4

24 Nov

Final day

Five-hour on-site final: finish, submit, present and judging

All deadlines follow Bangladesh Standard Time (UTC+6). A phase closes at 11:59 PM on its last date. Official communication is by email and the hackathon website - check spam folders too.

PRIZES

Tk 25,000 prize pool

2nd

Tk 8,000

1st

Tk 10,000

3rd

Tk 7,000

Prizes, categories and certificates are announced separately by the organizers.

RULES 2.1 - 2.5

Who can participate

Enrolled students

Open to currently enrolled students of any university in Bangladesh.

Cross-university

Teammates may come from different universities.

Valid student ID

Upload a clear ID image at registration. Show the original at check-in.

One team per person

A duplicate registration cancels every team that person appears in.

Not eligible

Organizers, judges, mentors and volunteers cannot participate.

True information

False or borrowed documents mean disqualification, even after results.

RULES 3.1 - 3.7

Team formation

Solo 1 member

Duo 2 members

Trio 3 members (max)

Team leader

One official contact, responsible for registration, payment and final submission.

Team name

Required for Duo and Trio, optional for Solo. No offensive, political or brand names.

Locked after 18 Nov

No adding, removing or replacing members. Emergencies: leader emails the organizers.

On final day

Absent member: compete short-handed, no substitute. Attendees stay on-site for the whole five-hour final.

RULES 4.1 - 4.2, 4.7 - 4.8

Phase 1: pre-registration form

Every member provides

- Full name and email
- Phone and WhatsApp number
- University name and student ID number
- Student ID card image
- T-shirt size (S, M, L, XL, XXL, XXXL)

How it works

- Free, open 12 - 18 Nov on the hackathon website
- Team leader submits one form for the whole team
- Confirmation email goes to every member
- No email in 24 hours? Contact the organizers
- Submissions cannot be edited - ask the organizers to fix an error before the deadline

RULES 4.3 - 4.6

The idea proposal

Project title
Required

Problem statement
Required

Proposed AI solution
Required

Proposal file
Required: PDF or DOCX

Technologies planned
Optional

Additional description
Optional

- One idea per team, and it must be the team's own original work
- AI tools may help write the proposal, but the team must be able to defend the idea
- Incomplete forms, unreadable IDs and corrupted files count as not submitted

RULES 5.1 - 5.5

Idea evaluation and Top 30

Problem clarity

A real, well-defined problem and a clear target user.

AI relevance

AI is central to the solution, not an add-on.

Feasibility

A working prototype can realistically be built in the three-day pre-build and the five-hour final.

Originality

A fresh idea or a new approach to a known problem.

Decisions are final. A waiting list may fill seats left unpaid.

1. Admin panel lists every team, member and idea file
2. Admins select the Top 30 ideas
3. Selected teams are emailed and may start building on 21 Nov

RULES 6.1 - 6.9

Phase 2: payment and confirmation

Tk 1,350

per team, one payment

bKash or Nagad Send Money

Pay by 11:59 PM, 23 Nov or the seat is lost, even if your team has started building.

Non-refundable and non-transferable, unless the organizers cancel the event.

1. Selection email arrives with the amount, receiving number and instructions
2. Pay only to the number in that email and on the official Payment page
3. Leader submits the sender's mobile number and Transaction ID (TrxID)
4. Organizers verify manually; the final confirmation email secures the seat
5. Organizers never ask for a PIN, OTP or password - report any such request

RULES 7.1 - 7.10

Rules on final day

Check-in

Every member shows the original student ID. Over 30 minutes late may mean refused entry.

Five continuous hours

The organizers' clock is the only reference. No extra time for late arrival.

Bring your own

Laptops, chargers, extension cords, hardware and backup mobile data.

Best-effort internet

A network failure is not grounds for extra time.

No outside help

Only registered members work on the project, during pre-build and the final. Hiring freelancers is cheating.

Mentors guide only

They answer questions but never write code. Stay in the hackathon area.

RULES 8.1 - 8.8

Project building rules

Until 20 Nov (before the shortlist)

- Research, planning, architecture diagrams
- UI wireframes and design mockups
- Collecting or choosing public datasets
- Creating accounts and API keys
- Learning frameworks and tools
- **No project-specific code yet**

From 21 Nov (pre-build, selected teams)

- Writing the project code
- Building the frontend, backend and database
- Training or fine-tuning models
- Deploying test versions
- On 24 Nov: finish, test, submit and present

Project code may be written only from 21 November, after the shortlist is published. Reusing an old, previously submitted or someone else's project is not allowed. Open-source libraries, public APIs, UI kits and official starters are allowed - list them in the README. Any product type is accepted; it must not be illegal, harmful, hateful or deceptive.

RULES 9.1 - 9.11

AI tools, models and data

Coding assistants OK

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Cursor and similar. Disclose each one in the README.

Models and APIs

OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini, Hugging Face, Groq, Ollama. Name each in the README.

Real AI only

Hard-coded, pre-recorded or human-faked AI output means disqualification.

Understand your code

Judges score what you designed and can explain, not volume of generated code.

Add real value

A bare prompt-forwarding wrapper scores low on innovation and technical depth.

Data and keys

Public, licensed or own data, credited. Bring your own API keys and credits.

RULES 10.1 - 10.10

GitHub repository

Repository rules

- One public repo, created on or after 21 Nov
- First code commit on or after 21 Nov
- Commit regularly from each member's own account; at least hourly during the final
- No force-push, squashing or back-dating
- Last commit before the final deadline on 24 Nov is judged
- Never commit keys; add a .env.example

README must contain

- Project, team and member names
- Problem and solution summary
- Features and how the AI works
- Tech stack, models, APIs, datasets
- AI tools used, and for what
- Third-party code and assets, credited
- Setup steps, live link, demo video

RULES 11.1 - 11.8

Deployment and live demo

Deploy publicly

- Live link built from your repo
- Free tiers are fine
- Stay live until results
- Login? Give test credentials

Can't deploy?

- Demo video, 3 minutes max
- Show the real project working
- Add an installable build, e.g. APK

Live demo

- Must run the real project
- Slides or recordings only as network backup
- Keep a local copy and recording

Hosting examples: Vercel, Netlify, Render, Railway, Hugging Face Spaces, Streamlit Cloud, Firebase, GitHub Pages.

RULES 12.1 - 12.6

Final submission checklist

Item	Requirement
Title and short description	Required, max 150 words
GitHub repository link	Required, public
Live deployment link	Required, or a demo video (rule 11.4)
Test login credentials	Required if the app has a login
AI tools and models disclosure	Required
Demo video	Optional, max 3 minutes

One submission per team, by the leader, before the five-hour final ends on 24 Nov. The deadline is strict - submit at least 10 minutes early. Links must be public; a broken or private link counts as missing.

RULES 13.1 - 13.8

Conduct and disqualification

Code of conduct

- Respect everyone; no harassment or abuse
- No smoking, alcohol, drugs or weapons
- Never touch another team's code or accounts
- Do not contact judges about scoring

Disqualification for

- Code started before 21 Nov, or an old or previously submitted project
- Plagiarism or copying another team
- Outside help during the pre-build or the final
- Faked demo or AI output
- Rewritten history or post-deadline changes
- False information or fake TrxID

Lesser breaches, such as a missing README item or undisclosed AI tool, can mean point deductions or a warning. Disqualified teams forfeit fee, prizes and certificates.

RULES 14 - 15

Ownership, privacy and general terms

Ownership and privacy

- Teams own their idea, code and project
- Organizers may show name, screenshots and demo, with credit
- You must respect licences and copyright
- ID images used only for verification
- Proposals are never shared with other teams
- Event photos and videos may be taken

General provisions

- Organizers may change schedule or rules, announced by email or website
- Postponed: registrations carry over
- Cancelled: fees are refunded
- You arrange your own travel and health cover
- Questions: Contact page or helpline
- Organizers' interpretation is final

HACKATHON FIELDS

Ten AI domains, in priority order

1
Healthcare
Direct human impact

2
Agriculture
Important for Bangladesh

3
Disaster Management
High national relevance

4
Education
Accessible to student innovators

5
Cybersecurity
Growing digital threats

6
Accessibility
Meaningful social innovation

7
Smart Cities
Practical urban challenges

8
Environment
Long-term sustainability

9
FinTech
Strong startup potential

10
Business and Industry
Commercial applications

Suggested: keep all 10 domains open. Each team picks one primary domain and optionally one secondary.

SAMPLE CHALLENGE

Real problems, not generic AI wrappers

Problem: rural healthcare access

A patient in a remote village gets a medical report but cannot understand the technical terms.

Your mission

Build an AI tool that explains reports in simple Bangla, flags key values and suggests questions for a doctor.

1. **Upload report**
2. **OCR text**
3. **Explain in Bangla**
4. **Flag out-of-range values**
5. **Medical disclaimer**

STILL TO CONFIRM

To be confirmed by the organizers

Payment numbers

Official bKash and Nagad receiving numbers

Final day schedule

Check-in, start, submission deadline, presentation times

Venue

Building and room

Prizes and certificates

Categories and certificates

Extras

Whether food, T-shirts, pen and notebook are provided

Contact (confirmed)

coutechnova2026@gmail.com and the helpline numbers on the website

AI FOR HUMANITY

Innovate Today. Transform Tomorrow.

Three days to build. Five hours to finish. Thirty teams. One mission: turn artificial intelligence into meaningful solutions for real-world problems.

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